

Every signal ties to a public record & carries a confidence tag. Reported June 27, 2026.
MED = real filing, outlets agree, primary image pending direct-API pull.

| THE SIGNAL · VERTICAL EDITION

THE SIGNAL · Hospitality

First word on every bar, restaurant & hotel — from the license and the permit, before the doors open.

ISSUE 001 · JUNE 2026 · a Brief Scout Media intelligence brief

THIS WEEK, FROM THE RECORD: state liquor boards · county health permits · building permits · bankruptcy dockets · SEC filings · M&A.
One reckoning reshaping the industry, and the openings & closings behind it.

PRESENTED BY HARBOR POS & PAYMENTS · SAMPLE SPONSOR

The restaurant and hotel business leaves the earliest paper trail of any industry — a liquor license is filed before the sign goes up, a WARN notice before the lights go off. We read those records so you know who's opening, expanding, and closing **before the press release**. Every line below is a real, recent record with a source and a confidence tag.

◆ LEAD SIGNAL · TRIANGULATION

The roll-up era is ending — capital is fleeing multi-brand debt and flowing to focused concepts

Read the bankruptcy dockets next to the M&A and it's one story: the securitized, many-brand roll-up is breaking, while private equity pays up for single, fast-growing concepts.

COLLAPSING

FAT Brands — Chapter 11 (Case 4:26-bk-90126, S.D. Tex.), ~\$1.3B debt, 18 brands / 2,200+ units; now filing a ~\$446M liquidation plan. HIGH
Shari's (Lena Brands) — Chapter 11 (D. Del.), down to 9 units after ~86 closures. MED
On the Border — owner moves from selective to full chain closure after its 2025 Ch. 11 "rescue." MED

CONSOLIDATING

Roark Capital bought a majority of **Dave's Hot Chicken** at ~\$1B (targeting up to 4,000 units). HIGH
Denny's taken private by a TriArtisan-led group, ~\$620M EV, closed Jan 16, 2026. MED-HIGH

THE READ The 2010s playbook — stack many brands on cheap securitized debt — is unwinding in the bankruptcy filings. The money isn't leaving hospitality; it's rotating to *focused*, single-concept growth stories (hot chicken, a beloved diner taken private to fix it offstage). Watch which orphaned FAT/Shari's brands get bought, and by whom.

► src: inforuptcy.com (FAT docket 4:26-bk-90126) · TheStreet (Shari's, OTB) · Restaurant Business / CNBC (Dave's/Roark) · Restaurant Dive (Denny's)

NOW POURING · LIQUOR LICENSES → OPENINGS

The highest-frequency feed in the whole model — a license is the earliest tell a venue is coming. (Boston's post-2024 license expansion alone produces an operator-named stream every board meeting; we'd diversify metros in production.)

Ama (the James Beard-nominated Comfort Kitchen team) — granted a full all-alcohol license for its 2nd concept at The Atlas, Allston MA. HIGH · ► boston.gov

Earls Kitchen + Bar — approved to take over a historic dive's Prohibition-era license for a new Seaport, Boston location. MED · ► universalhub.com

Boston upgrade batch (May 1) — 10 beer/wine → full-bar upgrades with named addresses (Beacon Hill's Willie's & Zurito, North End's Trattoria Al Dente & Benevento's). Cocktail menus imminent. MED-HIGH · ► bostonglobe.com

Biergarten — CA ABC Type 47 (full liquor) filing for an Oceanside, CA 2nd location near the pier. MED · ► sandiegoville.com

BREAKING GROUND · PERMITS & EXPANSION

Ritz-Carlton (Houston) — \$290M, 45-story condo-hotel (156 keys + 112 residences); dollar figure tied to a Texas TDLR filing, groundbreaking this summer. MED-HIGH · ► therealdeal.com

Bobby's Burgers (Bobby Flay) — 65-unit Canada area-development deal + a signed lease at Toronto's The Well (international debut). HIGH · ► qsr magazine.com

Port of Subs — three area-development deals signed into new metros: 50 units AZ, 20 Eastern VA, 70 DC metro. HIGH · ► franchise.org

Paris Baguette 500+ units in development (new states incl. CT, MO, OK) · **Hilton "Apartment Collection"** extended-stay debut in NY/DC/Atlanta. MED · ► chainstoreage.com, hospitalityinvestor.com

LAST CALL · THE FADE

W South Beach — Florida WARN: 337 jobs cut, hotel closes Aug 20, 2026 for a gut renovation (exits Marriott/Bonvoy). MED-HIGH · ► FL Dept. of Commerce WARN

Bahama Breeze (Darden) — winding down the 28-unit island concept (14 closed, 14 converted), confirmed in an FY26 Q3 8-K. HIGH · ► SEC 8-K

The squeeze, in tallies: Wendy's (~300+ units), Papa John's (~200 in 2026), Smokey Bones (all closed Apr 28). Mid-tier casual is pruning hard. MED · ► Restaurant Dive, NRN

THE DEAL SHEET · CAPITAL & CONCEPTS

Kasa × Mint House — all-equity merger of apartment-style hotel operators (~22 properties / ~1,000 units), \$40M from Silver Lake Waterman. Consolidation in "live-like-a-local" lodging. MED · ► PrivSource

"Saed" (K&D Restaurant Group) — a brand-new private-dining/beverage concept tipped its hand in an **SEC Form C** (EDGAR CIK 0002135043) before it has a storefront. Tiny raise — but a textbook "first word" from a primary filing. HIGH · ► sec.gov EDGAR

THE SIGNAL · HOSPITALITY PRO

Set a standing alert on *your* market: get pinged the moment a liquor license, health permit, restaurant build-permit, or WARN notice hits in any city or zip — plus the full

searchable openings & closings database. The tool every broker, supplier, and operator wishes they had. [\$XX/mo · sample]

[Start a free Pro trial →](#)

HOW WE SOURCED THIS: every item is a real, recent public record corroborated across independent outlets, with a confidence tag. HIGH = directly evidenced (court docket / SEC filing / official board release); MED = real record, outlets agree, primary image pending; LOW = single/promotional source. Production wires into state liquor boards, county permit portals, PACER, EDGAR & USPTO to clear every line to HIGH.

The Signal · Hospitality

A vertical edition of The Signal. Sponsor-supported & Pro-subscription intelligence from Brief Scout Media — every paid placement labeled, coverage never for sale, every claim tied to a public record. (Sister publication: the ad-free *Scenic City Insider*.)

[Forward to an operator who needs to know first →](#)
[Subscribe \(free\)](#) · [Go Pro](#) · [Sponsor](#) · [Tip us a filing](#)